A UX DESIGN CASE STUDY

Foodie Explorer

From recipe search to grocery order in one flow.

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THE PROBLEM

Dinner should not take all evening.

Busy professionals want home-cooked meals. They do not have hours to plan, shop, and cook.

The apps they have make it harder: hard to navigate, no personalization, uneven quality.

So time, food, and money get wasted, and takeout wins by default.

> **The gap: no single flow from finding a recipe to getting the groceries.**

THE WORK

Research first. Then design. Then test.

01

Research

Surveys and usability tests with busy professionals.

02

Design

Wireframes, then a working prototype in Figma.

03

Test

Two rounds of usability studies with real users.

04

Iterate

Redesigned on what users showed me.

Lead UX Designer and Researcher · 3–6 months

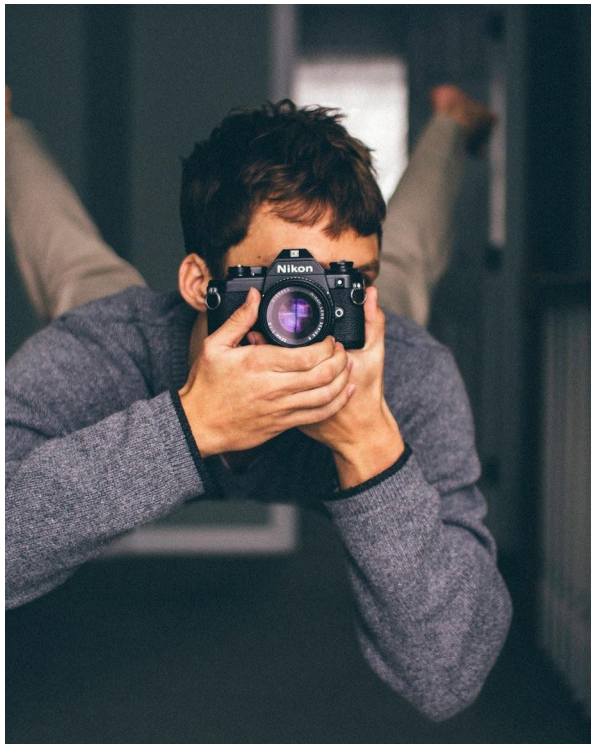
THE USER

Meet David.

David Miller, 42, freelance photographer, Portland, Oregon.

Married, two children, ages 8 and 10.

> *“Life’s too short for boring meals and grocery store lines. I need a solution that’s as creative as my photography.”*



Save time · Enjoy family time · Explore new foods · Support local businesses

Persona based on user research for this capstone project.

THE INSIGHT

Four frictions. Four ways to lose a customer.

01

Time

Every extra minute pushes users to takeout.

02

Quality

One bad delivery breaks trust.

03

Navigation

Can’t find it, can’t buy it.

04

Personalization

Generic suggestions waste time.

Research showed convenience was not enough. Users also wanted meal planning, visual guidance, and local businesses.

THE JOURNEY

Five moments that decide whether a customer stays.

1 **Learn**

Sees it, hears about it.

2 **Compare**

Researches, reads reviews.

3 **Buy**

Orders, pays, confirms.

4 **Receive**

Tracks it, checks quality.

5 **Stay**

Rates it, shares it, reorders.

Each stage is a place to lose a customer, or keep one.

THE SOLUTION

One flow: find it, list it, order it.

1

Find a recipe

Search by ingredients, diet, cuisine, or time.

→

2

Build the list

Ingredients become a shopping list with one tap.

→

3

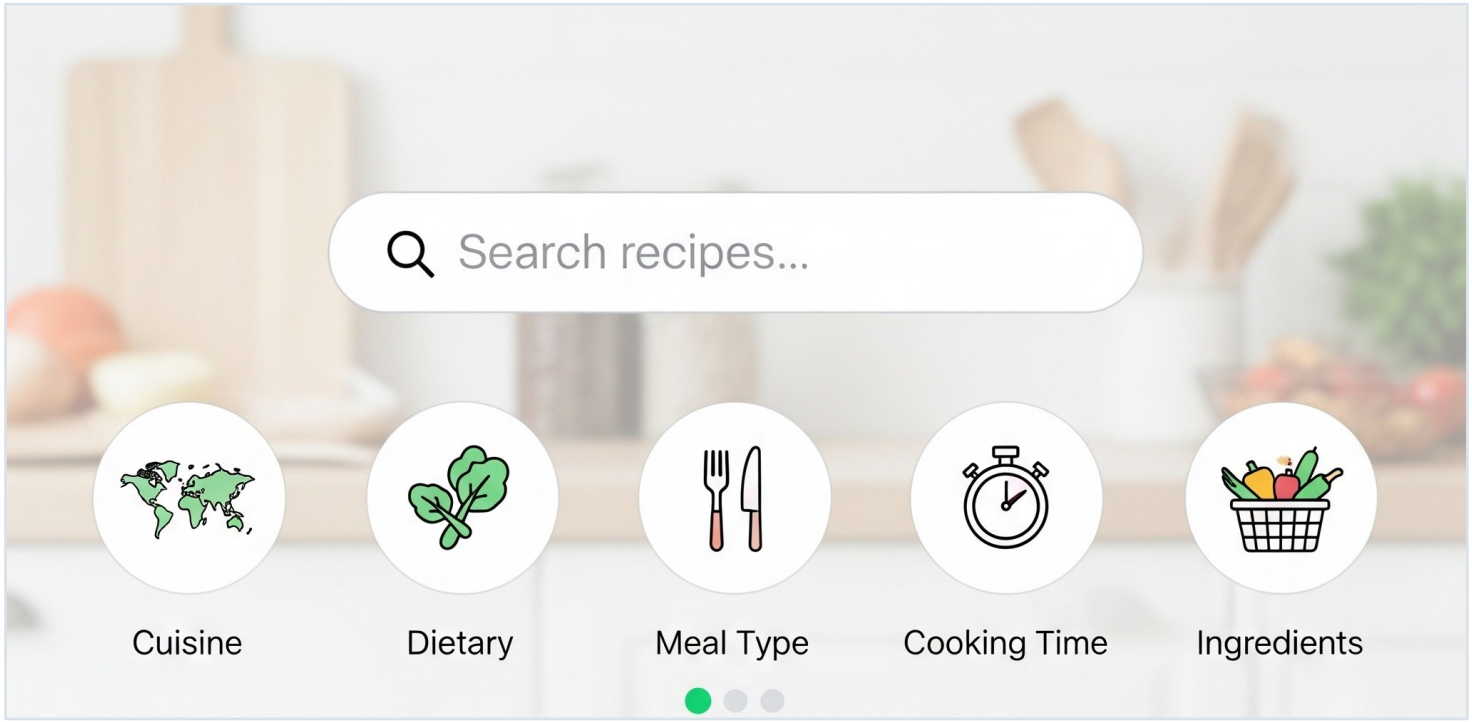
Order

One-page checkout. Delivery.

No retyping. No second app.

THE PRODUCT

Search the way people actually cook.



Filtered recipe search.

By the ingredients you already have.

By diet, cuisine, or cooking time.

Weeknight meals in 30 minutes or less.

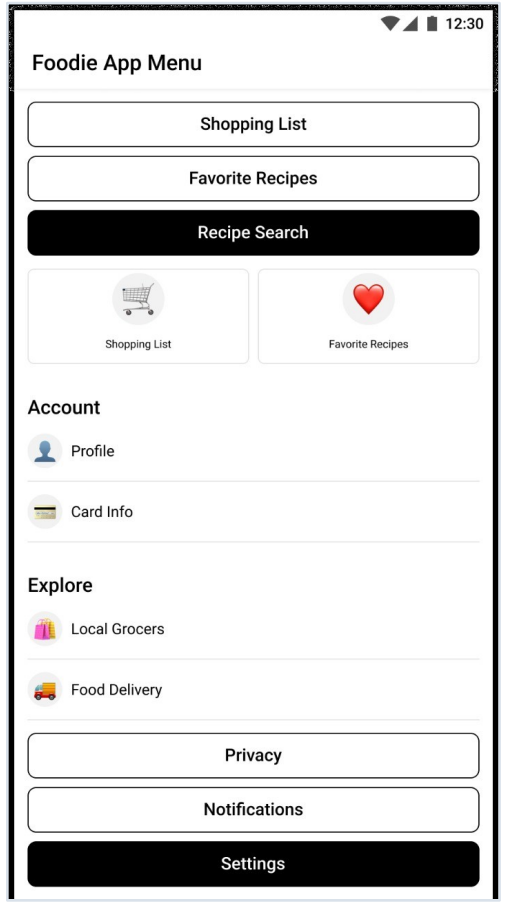
THE PRODUCT

One tap from recipe to grocery list.

Shopping list, favorite recipes, and recipe search in one menu.

Ingredients become a list automatically.

Checkout fits on one page.



The redesigned menu.

THE EVIDENCE

Tested with real users. Twice.

1

Intuitive search

Users found the search bar and filters easy to use. Recipe discovery got simpler.

2

Visual guides

Step-by-step visuals raised confidence, especially for new cooks.

3

Streamlined navigation

A minimalist design made moving through the app quick.

Round 1 sharpened accessibility and personalization. Round 2 made checkout faster.

THE EVIDENCE

What changed after testing.

BEFORE

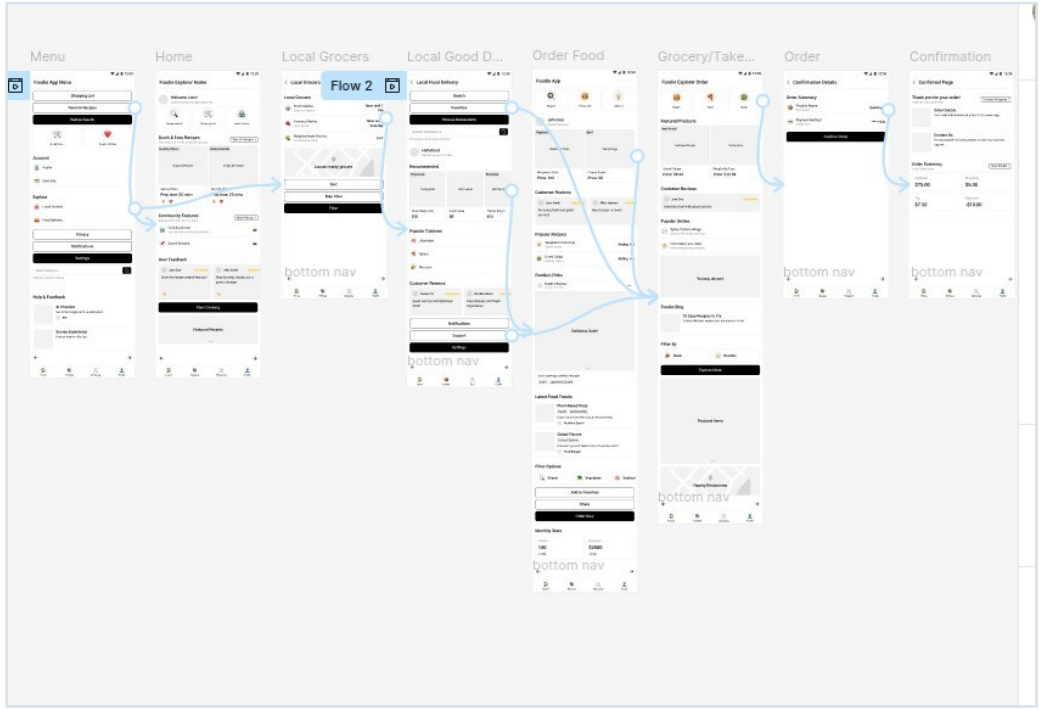
Simple layout, basic navigation.
No personalization.

No accessibility enhancements.

AFTER

Better search filters. Larger buttons.
Recommendations based on past orders

and dietary preferences.



The flows, connected in Figma: Home → search → grocery list → order → confirmation.

ACCESSIBILITY

More people can use it. Fewer need help.

1
High-contrast mode

Readable fonts and strong contrast. Text stays clear for users with low vision.

2
Voice search

Search by voice. Screen readers read every screen. No mouse needed.

3
Large tap targets

Clear navigation and big, well-spaced buttons. Fewer misclicks.

Accessibility is reach. It is also fewer support calls and fewer lost customers.

THE RESULT

A calmer, faster path from recipe to groceries.

> *“The app is so intuitive and saves me so much time. Now I can quickly find recipes and order groceries without stress!”*

Usability study participant

The redesign streamlined recipe discovery and grocery ordering, so users plan and prepare meals with less effort.

HOW I WORK

The way I would work with you.

1

Start with your users

Research before design. Surveys and usability tests, not guesses.

2

Test with real people

Two rounds of testing, then redesign on what they show me.

3

Build accessible from the start

High contrast, voice search, and screen readers, not bolted on later.

WHY ME

What this project proves.

1
Strategic thinking

I found the business problem behind the UX problem: time lost is a customer lost.

2
Research rigor

Surveys, usability studies, two test rounds. Decisions backed by evidence.

3
A tested redesign

I shipped a working prototype, tested it with real users, and improved it on their feedback.

LET'S TALK

Let's talk about your website.

Book a free 15-minute discovery call.

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